GDG Algiers ER Task 05: Three Days Before the Event

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I would deal first with catering, the budget gap and the unconfirmed main sponsor, send short holding replies on the rest, and give each problem an owner and a deadline.

What I would do

Priority	Problem	Action	Deadline
1	Catering company cancels	Call two or three alternatives today; ask a partner for in-kind drinks or snacks; reduce to a simpler menu if needed	Confirmed within 24 hours
2	Budget incomplete	List what is committed, what is missing and what is must-have versus optional; cut extras before core items	Done within a few hours, since it frames the other decisions
3	Main sponsor unconfirmed	Personal call today; give a clear decision date; prepare plan B without them	Answer within 24 hours
4	Extra visibility requested	Send a holding reply today; decide against the written agreement	Reply within 48 hours
5	Several late follow-ups	Triage by importance; send a short standard message; assign owners	Batch done by tomorrow; non-critical ones wait

What can wait: the extra visibility request and the follow-ups that are not tied to a need still uncovered. What cannot: food, money and the sponsor decision, because they hit attendees and the budget within days.

Why I would make this decision

Catering has a hard date and is the most visible failure, so it comes first. The budget gap comes next because it decides how much we can spend on the replacement. The sponsor cannot be forced, so I set a deadline and a plan B rather than keep waiting. The visibility request was not agreed, so I will not accept it under pressure: I check availability, conflicts and what other partners were promised, and accept only if it is fair and costs nothing or comes with an upgrade.

What solution or alternative I would propose

- **Catering:** a smaller menu of coffee, water and packaged snacks from a nearby supplier, or in-kind support from a partner.
- **Sponsor:** if no confirmation arrives by the deadline, the event runs without a title sponsor, and I do not print or announce their name until it is in writing.
- **Visibility:** offer a small, honest extra (for example a social post after the event), or point to the next package up.
- **Follow-ups:** one short message to each late contact, with a date by which we need an answer.

What I would do differently in the future

I would set go or no-go dates, for example sponsor confirmations two weeks before and caterers confirmed in writing one week before with a backup supplier on standby. I would hold a weekly budget review with a contingency line, handle extra requests through a written change process, and keep a follow-up tracker with an owner and a due date for every contact. Agreements would include cancellation terms.